

UK Visitor Visa (Tourist Visa) from India – FAQs

What is the UK Visitor Visa called?

The official visa category is the **Standard Visitor Visa**. It is used for:

- Tourism
- Visiting family/friends
- Short business visits
- Short-term study courses
- Medical treatment

Official UK Government page:

[UK Standard Visitor Visa – GOV.UK](#)

1. Do Indians need a visa to visit the UK?

Yes. Indian passport holders must apply for a UK Standard Visitor Visa before traveling. ([GOV.UK](#))

2. How long is the UK Visitor Visa valid?

Common options:

Visa Type	Validity	Stay Allowed
Standard Visitor Visa	6 months	Up to 6 months

Visa Type	Validity	Stay Allowed
Long-term Visitor Visa	2 years	6 months per visit
Long-term Visitor Visa	5 years	6 months per visit
Long-term Visitor Visa	10 years	6 months per visit

([GOV.UK](https://www.gov.uk))

3. What is the visa fee?

Current official fees:

Visa Type	Fee
6-month Visitor Visa	£135
2-year Visa	£506
5-year Visa	£903
10-year Visa	£1,128

([GOV.UK](https://www.gov.uk))

4. What documents are required?

Mandatory Documents

- Valid passport
- Old passports (if available)

- Passport-size photo (sometimes digital upload only)
- Visa application form
- Appointment confirmation

Financial Documents

- Last 6 months bank statements
- Salary slips (3–6 months)
- Income Tax Returns (ITR)
- Form 16 (optional but recommended)

Employment Proof

If employed:

- Employment letter
- Leave approval/NOC

If business owner:

- GST/business registration
- Company bank statements

If student:

- Bonafide certificate
- ID card

Travel Documents

- Tentative itinerary
- Hotel bookings

- Flight reservations (recommended but avoid non-refundable bookings before approval)

Additional Supporting Documents

- Cover letter
- Invitation letter (if visiting family/friends)
- Sponsor documents (if someone sponsors your trip)

([GOV.UK](#))

5. Is travel insurance mandatory?

No, it is not mandatory for UK visitor visas, unlike Schengen visas. However, travel insurance is highly recommended.

([Reddit](#))

6. How much bank balance is required?

There is no officially fixed minimum amount. But you should show:

- Sufficient funds for the trip
- Stable income
- Consistent banking history

Typical safer ranges many applicants maintain:

- Solo traveler: ₹2–5 lakhs+
- Family travel: Higher depending on duration

The key factor is:

- Your income should justify your expenses.
- Sudden large deposits can create suspicion.

7. What are the major rejection reasons?

Common rejection reasons:

- Insufficient funds
- Unclear source of money
- Weak ties to India
- Fake documents
- Inconsistent information
- Poor travel history
- Unclear travel purpose

Reddit applicant experiences show many refusals happen because applicants fail to explain:

- employment stability,
- financial support,
- family/property ties in India. ([Reddit](#))

8. Is a cover letter important?

Yes — very important.

A strong cover letter should explain:

- Purpose of travel
- Trip duration
- Funding source
- Employment details
- Return intentions
- Travel itinerary

Many successful applicants mention that detailed cover letters improved approval chances. ([Reddit](#))

9. How to apply step-by-step?

Step 1 – Apply Online

Use official UK Government portal:

[Apply for UK Visitor Visa](#)

Step 2 – Create Account

Create a UKVI account and fill the online form.

Step 3 – Pay Visa Fee

Pay online using:

- Credit card
 - Debit card
 - International payment methods
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Step 4 – Book Biometrics Appointment

Book appointment at a VFS Global center.

Popular centers in India:

- Hyderabad
 - Bengaluru
 - Chennai
 - Mumbai
 - Delhi
 - Ahmedabad
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Step 5 – Upload Documents

Either:

- Self-upload documents online
OR
 - Pay VFS to scan/upload
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Step 6 – Attend Biometrics

At VFS:

- Fingerprints taken
- Photograph taken
- Passport verified

Usually takes 30–60 minutes.

Step 7 – Wait for Decision

Typical processing:

- Standard: around 3 weeks
- Priority: faster (extra fee)

Some recent Indian applicants received decisions within 7–10 working days. ([GOV.UK](https://www.gov.uk))

10. Can I get priority processing?

Yes.

Priority services may reduce processing time to:

- ~5 working days
- Sometimes faster

Availability depends on VFS location.

11. Can I work in the UK on a visitor visa?

No.

You cannot:

- Take employment
- Do paid work (except limited permitted activities)
- Stay long-term

([GOV.UK](https://www.gov.uk))

12. Is interview required?

Usually no formal interview.

But UKVI may:

- Call you
 - Ask for additional documents
 - Conduct verification
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13. Is UK visa easy to get?

Approval depends on:

- Strong financials
- Stable employment
- Genuine travel intent
- Good documentation

Travel history to countries like:

- Schengen
- USA
- Singapore
- UAE

can help but is not mandatory.

14. Can family apply together?

Yes.

But:

- Each person needs a separate application
- Separate visa fee applies
- Separate biometrics required

([GOV.UK](https://www.gov.uk))

15. What happens after approval?

Traditionally, you receive:

- Passport with visa vignette/sticker

The UK is also gradually moving toward digital eVisas in 2026. ([The Times of India](#))

16. Best practices to improve approval chances

Recommended

- ☐ Maintain stable bank balance
- ☐ Submit genuine documents
- ☐ Provide detailed itinerary
- ☐ Show strong India ties
- ☐ Use proper cover letter
- ☐ Explain any unusual transactions

Avoid

- ☐ Fake hotel bookings
 - ☐ Sudden large bank deposits
 - ☐ Inconsistent travel plans
 - ☐ Fake employment documents
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Helpful Official Links

- [UK Visitor Visa Official Guide](#)
- [UK Immigration Rules for Visitors](#)

Helpful Video Guides

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[UK Visitor VISA from INDIA | Entire Process Explained](#)

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[UK Visitor Visa From India – Documents & Application Process](#)

If you want, I can also help with:

- UK visa document checklist for salaried employees
- Cover letter sample
- Invitation letter format
- Detailed VFS appointment process
- Visa approval tips for first-time travelers
- UK family visa FAQ
- Sample itinerary for tourism visa
- UK visa rejection analysis and reapply strategy